Facilitator Resource Guide

Grant Writing & Fundraising Training

This guide supports facilitators delivering the training on grant writing and fundraising skills to community groups, NGOs, or project leaders.

The training focuses on helping participants learn how to find financial support to run and grow their projects.

1. Training Objectives

By the end of the session, participants should be able to:

- Understand what grant writing and fundraising are.
- Identify the main parts of a grant proposal.
- Create a basic project narrative.
- Understand how to develop a simple budget.
- Identify potential donors.
- Recognize the importance of relationships and partnerships.

2. Suggested Training Flow

Section	Time	Method
Introduction to Fundraising	10 minutes	Discussion
Writing Grant Proposals	25 minutes	Explanation + Example
Budgeting	15 minutes	Demonstration
Finding Donors	15 minutes	Group brainstorming
Stakeholder Relationships	10 minutes	Discussion
Coalitions & Advocacy	10 minutes	Case example
Action Planning	10 minutes	Individual work

3. Opening Discussion

Start the session with questions to participants.

Ask:

Question

Where does money for community projects usually come from?

Possible responses:

- Donors
- Government
- Community contributions
- NGOs
- Businesses

Explain:

Grant writing and fundraising are skills that help organizations ask for support effectively so they can continue helping people.

4. Understanding Grant Proposals

Explain that a grant proposal is a written request for funding that explains:

- What the organization wants to do
- Why the project is important
- How much money is needed
- How the money will be used

Tell participants that most proposals have two major components:

1. Narrative (story)
2. Budget (numbers)

Both are necessary for donors to understand the project.

5. Explaining the Proposal Narrative

Walk participants through the five key elements.

1. The Problem

Explain the issue your project is addressing.

Facilitator question:

What problem exists in your community that needs attention?

2. Your Solution

Explain what your organization will do.

Facilitator prompt:

How will your project solve this problem?

3. Who Will Benefit

Clearly describe the people who will be helped.

Examples:

- Children
- Youth
- Women
- Farmers
- Community members

4. Your Plan

Describe the activities step by step.

Example structure:

- Month 1: Preparation
- Month 2: Purchase materials
- Month 3: Begin activities

5. Expected Results

Explain what changes will happen after the project.

Examples:

- Increased literacy
- Improved health

- More school attendance

6. Activity: Create a Mini Proposal

Ask participants to work individually or in pairs.

They should write:

1. One community problem
2. One project solution
3. Who will benefit
4. One expected result

Invite volunteers to share their ideas.

7. Understanding Budgets

Explain that a budget shows how money will be used.

Common budget categories include:

- Staff salaries
- Materials
- Transportation
- Rent
- Training
- Equipment

Important facilitator message:

Donors want to see that money will be spent carefully and realistically.

8. Budget Exercise

Ask participants:

What expenses might your project require?

Write responses on a board under categories like:

- People
- Materials

- Activities
- Operations

This helps participants see that every project needs a clear financial plan.

9. Finding Donors (Donor Mapping)

Explain that donor mapping means identifying possible supporters who care about your cause.

Main donor categories include:

1. Foundations
2. Government grants
3. Companies
4. Individual donors

Explain that not every donor funds every cause, so organizations must research carefully.

10. Activity: Donor brainstorm

Ask participants to list five possible donors for their project.

Examples could include:

- Local businesses
- Churches
- Community leaders
- Government departments
- NGOs

Participants should write down:

- Donor name
- Contact method
- Why they might support the project

11. Building Relationships with Stakeholders

Explain that stakeholders are people who care about or are affected by the project.

Examples include:

- Community members
- Local leaders
- Volunteers
- Donors
- Partner organizations

Key facilitator message:

Strong relationships increase trust and support.

Ways to build relationships:

- Listen to community needs
- Communicate regularly
- Involve stakeholders in decisions
- Show appreciation
- Be transparent

12. Coalition Building

Explain that a coalition is when organizations work together toward a common goal.

Benefits include:

- Stronger voice
- Shared resources
- Greater impact

Facilitator question:

Which organizations in your community could you partner with?

13. Advocacy Basics

Advocacy means speaking to decision-makers to create positive change.

Common strategies:

- Share stories
- Meet leaders

- Collect evidence
- Use media
- Build alliances

Explain that advocacy can help influence policy and attract support.

14. Reflection Activity

Ask participants:

1. What is one project idea you could propose for funding?
2. Who are three possible donors?
3. Which partner organization could support you?

15. Key Messages to Reinforce

Before closing the session, remind participants:

- Good proposals clearly explain the problem and the solution
- A clear budget builds trust with donors
- Finding the right donors saves time
- Strong relationships make fundraising easier
- Partnerships create bigger impact

16. Post-Training Assignment

Encourage participants to complete the following within one month:

1. Write a 1-page project proposal
2. Create a basic budget
3. Identify 5 potential donors
4. Meet with one community stakeholder